JavaScript is disabled on your browser.

compact1, compact2, compact3

java.nio.file.attribute

Class UserPrincipalLookupService

java.lang.Object
    java.nio.file.attribute.UserPrincipalLookupService

```
public abstract class UserPrincipalLookupService
extends Object
```

An object to lookup user and group principals by name. A `UserPrincipal` represents an identity that may be used to determine access rights to objects in a file system. A `GroupPrincipal` represents a *group identity*. A `UserPrincipalLookupService` defines methods to lookup identities by name or group name (which are typically user or account names). Whether names and group names are case sensitive or not depends on the implementation. The exact definition of a group is implementation specific but typically a group represents an identity created for administrative purposes so as to determine the access rights for the members of the group. In particular it is implementation specific if the *namespace* for names and groups is the same or is distinct. To ensure consistent and correct behavior across platforms it is recommended that this API be used as if the namespaces are distinct. In other words, the `lookupPrincipalByName` should be used to lookup users, and `lookupPrincipalByGroupName` should be used to lookup groups.

Since:

1.7

See Also:

`FileSystem.getUserPrincipalLookupService()`

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Modifier	Constructor	Description
protected	UserPrincipalLookupService()	Initializes a new instance of this class.

Method Summary

Abstract Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
abstract GroupPrincipal	lookupPrincipalByGroupName(String group)	Lookup a group principal by group name.
abstract UserPrincipal	lookupPrincipalByName(String name)	Lookup a user principal by name.

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Object

clone, equals, finalize, getClass, hashCode, notify, notifyAll, toString, wait, wait, wait

Constructor Detail

UserPrincipalLookupService

```
protected UserPrincipalLookupService()
```

Initializes a new instance of this class.

Method Detail

lookupPrincipalByName

```
public abstract UserPrincipal lookupPrincipalByName(String name)
                                             throws IOException
```

Lookup a user principal by name.

Parameters:

`name - the string representation of the user principal to lookup`

Returns:

`a user principal`

Throws:

`UserPrincipalNotFoundException - the principal does not exist`

`IOException - if an I/O error occurs`

`SecurityException - In the case of the default provider, and a security manager is installed, it checks RuntimePermission("lookupUserInformation")`

lookupPrincipalByGroupName

```
public abstract GroupPrincipal lookupPrincipalByGroupName(String group)
                                                    throws IOException
```

Lookup a group principal by group name.

Where an implementation does not support any notion of group then this method always throws `UserPrincipalNotFoundException`. Where the namespace for user accounts and groups is the same, then this method is identical to invoking `lookupPrincipalByName`.

Parameters:

`group - the string representation of the group to lookup`

Returns:

`a group principal`

Throws:

`UserPrincipalNotFoundException - the principal does not exist or is not a group`

`IOException - if an I/O error occurs`

```
SecurityException - In the case of the default provider, and a
security manager is installed, it checks
RuntimePermission("lookupUserInformation")
```


Submit a bug or feature
For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.
Copyright © 1993, 2026, Oracle and/or its affiliates. All rights reserved. Use is subject to license terms.
Also see the documentation redistribution policy.

Scripting on this page tracks web page traffic, but does not change the content in any way.